1. What pair of words also means “denotation/connotation”?

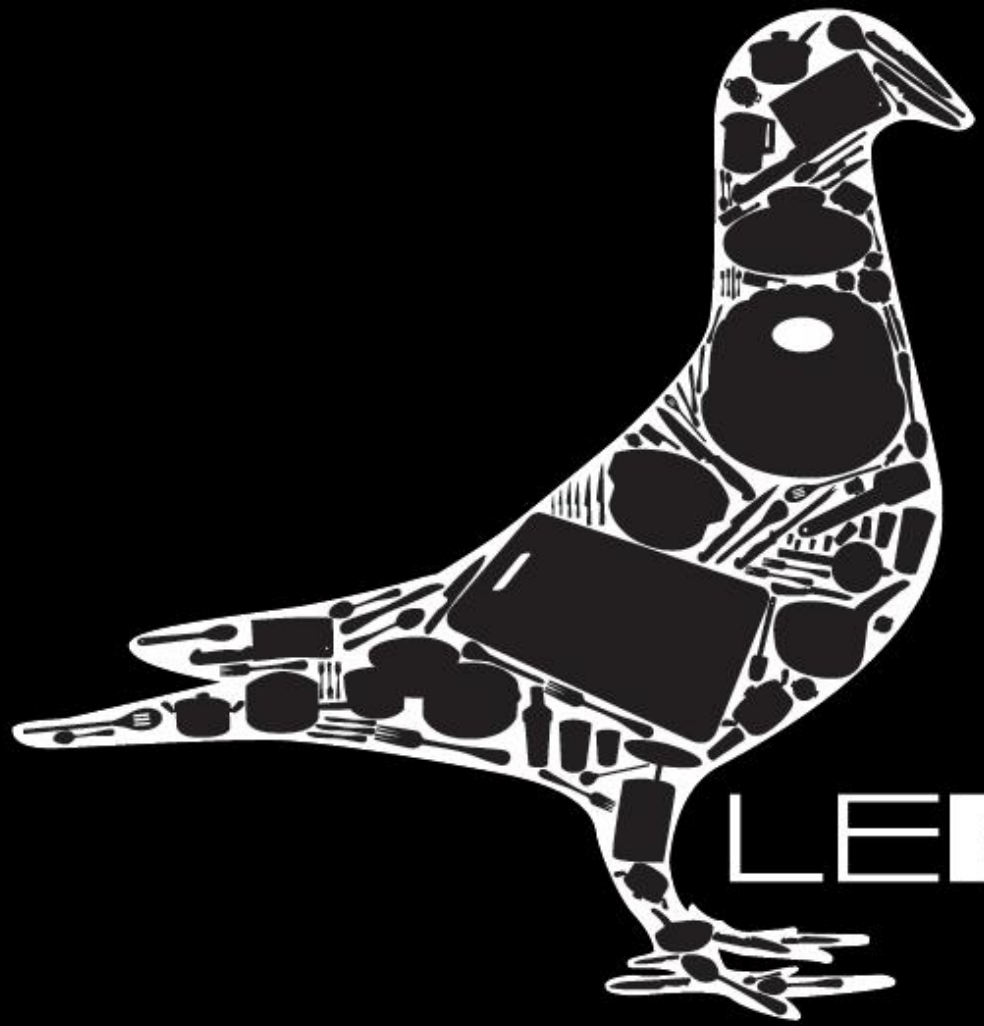
- ○ stupid/smart
- ○ ugly/pretty
- ○ obvious/opaque
- ○ clear/ambiguous
- ◉ literal/suggestive

✓ **Correct**

Denotation is the literal meaning of a design. Connotative suggests meaning through symbolism or association.

2. The image below is a logo for Le Pigeon, a restaurant in Portland, Oregon designed by Ian Lynam. **Choose all of the responses that are *denotative* readings of the logo below.**

   Hint: denotative = something that is literally represented, without any interpretation.



LEPIGEON

- [x] this logo uses negative space to create visual interest

> ✓ **Correct**
> This accurately describes a visual component of the logo.

- [ ] this restaurant only serves people and their pet pigeons
- [x] the logo uses a silhouette of a pigeon

> ✓ **Correct**
> This accurately describes a visual component of the logo.

- [ ] this restaurant is "for the birds" (this is an American expression describing something as “useless or meaningless")
- [ ] pigeons are considered unclean in some cultures and are inappropriate for a restaurant logo
- [x] there appear to be the tools of cooking and baking in the outline of the pigeon

> ✓ **Correct**
> This accurately describes a visual component of the logo.

3. **Choose the all of the responses that best explain the *connotative* meaning of the logo shown in the previous question (#2).**

Hint: connotative = meanings or interpretations that are suggested by the logo.

- [x] this restaurant might be expensive

✓ **Correct**
This is a value judgement derived from an interpretation of the logo.

- [x] it feels unpretentious and down to earth

✓ **Correct**
This is a value judgement derived from an interpretation of the logo.

- [ ] color is not used in this logo

- [x] this restaurant feels contemporary and artisanal

✓ **Correct**
This is a value judgement derived from an interpretation of the logo.

- [x] this restaurant seems like it is for a younger, more urban clientele

✓ **Correct**
This is a value judgement derived from an interpretation of the logo.

4. Look at the image depicting variations of Apple Inc.'s stylized apple logo. Why does this logo work as a visual metaphor for the company (Apple Inc.)?

   Hint: visual metaphor = an image that is representative or symbolic of something else, especially something abstract such as an idea

Google

apple logo

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File:Apple logo black.svg - ...
commons.wikimedia.org

Apple Logo Design ...
inkbotdesign.com

Apple logo | Logok
logok.org

computer ipad iphone softw...
vectorstock.com

Apple logo | Logok
logok.org

Apple logo PNG png downl...
kisspng.com

Apple made for its October 30t...
theverge.com

The true story behind the App...
arabianbusiness.com

- ○ apples and computers are completely different things
- ○ apples are cheap and so are computers
- ○ computers are harvested out of factories
- ◉ the apple symbolizes the fruit of the tree of knowledge
- ○ apples are easy to use and so are Apple's computers

✓ **Correct**

An apple is often understood to symbolize forbidden knowledge. In the case of Apple Inc. this can be understood as a metaphor for giving people access to knowledge.

5. Look at this screenshot depicting the Statue of Liberty as the cover of the May/June 2019 issue of *Foreign Affairs* titled "Searching for a Strategy" on the magazine's website. **What does the Statue of Liberty as it is used in the illustration at the top of the page symbolize?**

   Hint: Pay attention to context! The Statue of Liberty may symbolize many things, but you're being asked to focus on what it stands for in this illustration in particular.

Searching for a Strategy | 01 This Time Is Different | 02 The Open World | 03 The End of Hubris | 04 Back to Basics

What's Inside

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- ○ The search for a grand strategy
- ○ The use of art in a grand strategy
- ◉ The United States
- ○ Donald Trump
- ○ Hope

✓ **Correct**

The Statue of Liberty has been a symbol of the United States since the 19th century.

6. In the same illustration mentioned in the previous question (#5), the Statue of Liberty's torch is substituted for a flashlight. **This visual metaphor (Statue of Liberty + flashlight) conveys what meaning or idea?**

- ○ Flashlights are the new fire
- ○ The United States has a power crisis
- ○ It's night time
- ○ America is a country of immigrants
- ◉ The search for a grand strategy

✓ **Correct**

The combination of the Statue of Liberty and a flashlight is a metaphor for the search for a grand strategy, which in the context of this article is about US foreign policy.

- [ ] It expresses a human emotion.
- [ ] It is well crafted.
- [ ] It appears on a computer screen.
- [x] Its form directly reflects the thing it represents.

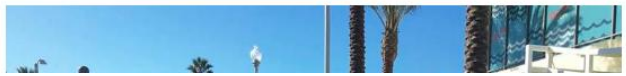
✓ **Correct**
This icon renders a human smile in the form of an emoji.

- [ ] It is yellow.
- [x] It is denotative.

✓ **Correct**
Icons are denotative. As a first read they are very literal and easy to understand..

21058 PCH
GM2015
NO PARKING
HOW WILL YOU
Burger
LOT 570

Pacific
CITY
21022



8. Look at this screenshot depicting the Pacific City hand waves mural by Geoff McFetridge on the Otto Design Group's website. **Which of the following statements best describe the use of hands in the mural depicted in the left-side of the image above?**

- ○ Cliche: hands are an overused image and in this example, they are not used in an original or surprising way
- ○ Arbitrary: hands are an overused image and in this example, have no relationship to the main idea
- ○ Original: hands are rarely used as visual metaphors in imagery
- ◉ Inventive: hands are an overused form, but in this example, they are used in an original and surprising way

✓ **Correct**

The use of the hands in unusual. Formally the hands are not acting like hands, they form part of a pattern that looks like a wave or landscape.

9. Take a look at this screenshot depicting variations of the logo for Adorama, a store and website that sells photo, video, and electronics equipment. **Which of the following statements best describe the use of camera 'eye' or iris in the logo?**

Google

adorama camera store logo

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podcast | coupon codes | los angeles | discounts | nikon | deals | canon | pror

Digital Cameras, Lenses, Pro Audio ...
adorama.com

Adorama News : Creative COW
news.creativecow.net

adorama-logo - Art of Visuals
artofvisuals.com

- (●) Cliche: eyes are an overused image and in this example, they are not used in an original or surprising way
- ( ) Original: eyes are rarely used as visual metaphors in imagery
- ( ) Inventive: although eyes are an overused image, but in this example, they are used in an original and surprising way
- ( ) Arbitrary: eyes are an overused image and in this example, have no relationship to the main idea.

✓ **Correct**

This logo uses a common trope or cliche of the lens aperture of a camera as eye.

During President Obama's inauguration on the Capitol steps, he stood behind a lectern, as he always does when speaking in public, adorned with the Seal of the President of the United States. Later that evening, after the ceremonies and parades, he danced across the symbol with the First Lady. It's on the floor of the Oval Office and on stamped on the Presidential Physical Fitness Award certificate (or so I'm told). The Presidential Seal is one of the most recognizable symbols in the world and one of the few examples of American heraldry, but who designed it?

The modern seal of the President of the United States (image: whitehouse.gov)

RAMONES
OFFICIAL ONLINE STORE

MENU CART

LOGO STICKER

Sold Out

5" diameter high-quality vinyl Ramones logo sticker.

How would you characterize the Ramones logo when compared to the Seal of the President of the United States?

- (●) The Ramones are appropriating the Seal of the President of the United States as a kind of parody and political commentary.
- ( ) It is meant to associate the Ramones with a source of political power and control, making the Ramones look better by association.
- ( ) It is an amateurish knock off with no redeeming value.
- ( ) The Ramones have aspirations for political office and this is an attempt to brand themselves as politicians.
- ( ) The Ramones are a terrible band and they have a terrible logo.

✓ **Correct**

This is a deliberate appropriation that is a parody of an official seal. It is meant a way to mock and criticize authority.

11. What does the bad craft and deliberate mistakes (substituting a baseball bat for arrows in the eagle's claw) in the Ramones logo shown in the previous question (#12) signify?

- ( ) An inexperienced designer who needs to learn their craft.
- ( ) A lack of attention to detail.
- (●) It is an attempt to use graphic design to make fun of the original seal and establish the band as counter-cultural in attitude.
- ( ) A desire to establish a clear visual hierarchy.
- ( ) It signifies the appropriation of a low-brow cultural aesthetic.

✓ **Correct**

This appears to be the intention of the deliberately appropriating the seal badly with mistakes. The parody comes from the intentionally bad imitation.

- ○ The birds are symbolic of the phases of life
- ◉ The birds are treated as characters and the book design is crucial to telling their story.
- ○ The use of color in the book is very effective
- ○ Birds and books both use trees in different ways.
- ○ It is a parody of a children's book.

✓ **Correct**

This is a good working definition of what a narrative is.

Which of the following statements describe how Lester Beall used symbolic language in his work?

- ○ Beall used symbolism in his designs to promote government agencies as a way to add complexity and nuance.
- ○ Beall used symbolism to get the most meaning out of the fewest elements possible.
- ○ Beall used symbolism by using the colors of the American flag to indicate that the US government is behind certain beneficial programs.
- ◉ All of the statements presented describe how Lester Beall used symbolic language in his work according to the video.

✓ **Correct**

14. Watch this title sequence for *Cosmos: A Spacetime Odyssey* (2014) on the Art of the Title website and examine how the human eye is used in the sequence. **Which of the following statements best describe the use of human eye in the title sequence?**

Hint: You may find it helpful to read the text and interview below the video, in particular, the answer to "Let's talk about the first set of boards and the direction you went."

- ○ Unoriginal and badly crafted
- ◉ Well-produced and executed, but borderline cliche. Zooming in and out of an eye has been used countless times in film.
- ○ Startling and original. This trope really sells the idea that humans are at the center of the universe and are the only species that matters.

✓ **Correct**

This is a very well-executed piece of motion and computer graphics. It could be considered a cliche since it uses the trope of zooming in and out of a human eye. At the same time this piece is also attempting to show the evolution of the human eye, which is somewhat original.